Darjeeling who knows more about conditions along the border than anyone else I have met; and local officials in Gangtok, Sikkim. In Siliguri, northern West Bengal, I met Abhijeet Mazumdar, son of the late Naxalite firebrand Charu Mazumdar, and I have on numerous previous occasions met and interviewed Naga, Mizo, and Manipuri rebels from India's northeast who underwent training in China in the 1960s and 1970s. I have also met and interviewed rebels from the United Liberation Front of Assam, among them their top leaders Arabinda Rajkhowa and Paresh Barua. In Nepal, I met veteran journalist and author Kanak Mani Dixit and others from the local media as well as researchers from international entities who study violent conflicts in the region. I also visited refugee camps in southern Nepal, where ethnic Nepalese from Bhutan have been sheltered since the early 1990s. In Bhutan, I was able to discuss China-related issues with several government officials, who, however, preferred not to be named. Julian Gearing, an expert on Tibet, helped with the unenviable task of guiding me through the maze of Tibetan sects, an often bewildering aspect to the outside observer of the Buddhist world of the Himalayas. I am also thankful to Alastair Lamb, whom I met when I was doing research at the British Library in January 2016. Although I disagree with his presentations and conclusions, Lamb proved to be generous with information and even gave me some of his books. I never tried to contact Neville Maxwell, but apart from reading *India's China War*, I also read his other, lesser-known book, *China's Borders: Settlements and Conflicts* as well as several articles by him that have appeared over the years in the *Economic and Political Weekly*.[33]

It is, of course, impossible to be completely accurate when it comes to a heated and controversial issue like the dispute between India and China, with its many conflicting and contradictory accounts of history and current events. But I have, to the best of my ability, presented here a comprehensive and nuanced picture of the conflict; why and how it began; what it became; and the meaning of it all in the realities of today's Asia. Any factual errors are entirely my own, for which my sources, written as well as oral, should not be blamed.